



Don't underestimate the power of shipping to attract customers or drive them away

think about it, it's the crux of any ecommerce store isn't it? Apart from ensuring that the order is actually fulfilled and being just another step in the entire process, it has become an USP of stores. There is a war between the big ecommerce stores to ensure swifter delivery, so much that we see Amazon now offering same day delivery. All this is in an effort to blur the lines between offline and online shopping and give the customers the instant gratification experienced in traditional retail shopping. Given this backdrop, where do your shipping/ delivery solutions stand at? Are you competitive? Are you offering the least possible shipping time at the minimum possible cost? How do you ensure that your packages are not lost in transit or damaged? Should you have an in-house delivery system or outsource it? So many questions! Let's take a deep breath and dive into the complex world of near perfect logistics.

To begin with, devote a chunk of your time and planning to this area in the pre-launch stage. You need to be able to get this up and running as soon as your site goes live. Before we move on to the actual delivery, let's look at a few other things you should consider.

Free Shipping Vs. Customer Charged

This is the biggest question of all. Your first thought is 'free shipping' equals 'absolute customer loyalty', right? Customers would love not paying